

AN OSPREY
CAN **CARRY**
PREY
WEIGHING
AROUND
2 LB
(1 KG)—HALF
ITS OWN BODY
WEIGHT

AN OSPREY'S
WINGSPAN
MAY BE UP TO
6 FT
(2 M) WIDE



Passing through

In the northern parts of their range, ospreys are seasonal visitors, arriving to hunt and breed in spring and summer, before migrating south to avoid the bitter winters.

Breeding pair

Ospreys start breeding at around three years old. Typically, a male mates with a single female, but if he can defend two nests, he might have a second partner.

Year-round residents

In warmer parts of the world, such as southern Asia, some populations of osprey are resident throughout the year and do not migrate.

Smaller birds

The ospreys in Southeast Asia, New Guinea, and Australia are slightly smaller than those in the rest of the world. Some scientists think that they belong to a different species.

Winter visitors

Across sub-Saharan Africa, ospreys are winter visitors, traveling from Europe at the end of the northern summer. Only in Egypt and other parts of northeastern Africa are they resident all year.

Worldwide raptor

The osprey is one of the world's most wide-ranging birds. It lives almost everywhere there is water to fish, except for the cold polar regions and the remotest islands. Birds in the northern hemisphere migrate south for the winter, but ospreys around the equator tend to stay in the same place all year round.

Waterside nests

Ospreys nest along the shores of lakes and rivers or by marshes, typically choosing an exposed tree in which to build a platform of sticks before laying a clutch of three eggs. The first-born chicks are the strongest— younger ones may be left to starve if food is scarce.



OSPREYS
MIGRATING
FROM **AFRICA**
TO **EUROPE**
IN SUMMER
TRAVEL UP TO
5,000
MILES
(8,000 KM)